

Chapter 6

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Worksheet for Chapter 6: Professionalism and Networking: Creating Opportunities After High School

Instructions: Complete each section of this worksheet thoughtfully. Use the space provided to write your answers. Refer to Chapter 6 in "Soft Skills for Success After High School" if you need guidance. Be prepared to discuss your responses with a classmate or teacher.

Part 1: Building a Professional Image – Reflect and Plan

Objective: Assess your current professional image and create a plan to improve reliability, attire, and behaviour in preparation for college or workplace settings. **Task:** Think about how you present yourself now and how you can enhance your professional image for future opportunities. Answer the questions below and develop a mini-action plan.

- **Reliability Check:** Think of a recent time you made a commitment (e.g., to a friend, teacher, or family member). Did you follow through? If yes, how did it feel to be dependable? If no, what stopped you, and how can you improve next time?
- **Attire Assessment:** Do you have at least one outfit ready for a professional setting (like an interview or event)? Describe it or note what you need to get. How does dressing appropriately make you feel more confident?
- **Behaviour Reflection:** Recall a recent interaction with a teacher, coach, or boss. Did you use polite language, make eye contact, or show respect? Write one behaviour you did well and one you could improve (e.g., not interrupting, avoiding phone distractions).

Mini-Action Plan: Choose one area (reliability, attire, or behaviour) to focus on this week. Write a specific goal (e.g., "I'll be on time to every class" or "I'll practice saying thank you more"). How will you track your progress?

Part 2: Networking for Future Success – Map Your Connections

Objective: Identify potential networking opportunities and practice reaching out to build relationships for career or college growth. **Task:** Create a networking map of people and resources you can tap into, then draft a plan to connect with at least one person or opportunity.

- **Who You Know:** List three people in your current circle (e.g., family, teachers, friends' parents) who could help with career or college goals. Next to each, write their job or role and one question you could ask them for advice or a connection.
 - Person 1: _____ Role: _____ Question: _____
 - Person 2: _____ Role: _____ Question: _____
 - Person 3: _____ Role: _____ Question: _____
- **Expanding Your Circle:** Research one upcoming event or opportunity (e.g., school career fair, community

workshop, college open house) where you could meet new people. Write the event name, date, and two questions you'd ask someone there to start a conversation. If no event is available, suggest an online platform like LinkedIn and a type of person to connect with.

- Event/Platform: _____ Date (if applicable): _____
- Question 1: _____
- Question 2: _____

- **Giving Back:** Networking is a two-way street. For one person or connection you plan to reach out to, write how you could show gratitude or offer value (e.g., a thank-you note, helping with a small task).

Reflection Question: 4. What makes you nervous about networking, if anything? How can starting with people you know help ease that fear?

Part 3: First Impressions in Professional Spaces – Practice and Polish

Objective: Develop and rehearse skills for making strong first impressions through introductions, body language, and professional conduct. **Task:** Craft a personal introduction and simulate professional interactions to build confidence for real-world scenarios.

- **Craft Your Introduction:** Write a short (10-15 second) introduction for two settings: (a) a job interview and (b) a college club meeting. Include your name, a relevant fact about yourself, and a friendly closer. Practice saying it aloud.
 - Job Interview Intro: _____
 - College Club Intro: _____
- **Body Language Check:** Think about how you present yourself nonverbally. Do you stand tall, make eye contact, or smile when meeting someone new? List one body language habit you do well and one to improve (e.g., stop fidgeting, avoid crossing arms).
 - Strength: _____
 - Area to Improve: _____
- **Professional Conduct Scenario:** Imagine you're at a job interview, and you accidentally arrive 5 minutes late due to traffic. Write how you'd apologize and recover gracefully to maintain a positive impression.

Practice Activity: Pair up with a classmate, friend, or family member. Role-play introducing yourself in one of the settings above. Ask for feedback on your tone, confidence, and body language. Note one thing you did well and one thing to work on.

- What I Did Well: _____
- What to Work On: _____

Reflection Question: 5. How did practicing your introduction or body language make you feel? What's one first impression skill you'll use in a real situation soon?

Part 4: Putting It All Together – Real-World Scenario

Objective: Apply professionalism, networking, and first impression skills to a realistic post-high school scenario.

Task: Read the scenario below and answer the questions that follow.

Scenario: It's your first week as a college freshman, and you're also looking for a part-time job. Today, you're attending a campus career fair to explore job options and network with employers. You've dressed neatly, but you're nervous about introducing yourself. During the event, you meet a local business owner who's hiring, but you only have a few minutes to make an impression before they move on to another student. Later, you're invited to join a study group with classmates who might know about other job leads.

- **Professional Image:** How will you show reliability and professional behavior at the career fair (e.g., arriving early, speaking politely)? What attire would you wear, and why?

- **Networking:** What's one question you'd ask the business owner to learn more about the job and build a connection? How would you follow up after the event to show interest (e.g., email, thank-you note)?
- **First Impression:** Write a short introduction to use when meeting the business owner. How will you ensure your body language (e.g., handshake, eye contact) supports a confident impression?

Part 5: Self-Reflection

Objective: Reflect on how the skills from Chapter 6 can prepare you for success after high school. **Questions:** 6. Which skill (building a professional image, networking, or making first impressions) do you think will be most important for your future, and why? Give an example of how you might use it.

- What's one small action you can take this week to start practicing one of these skills (e.g., updating your wardrobe, reaching out to a connection, practicing an intro)? Who can help hold you accountable?